

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12401228
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	August 26, 2025
Inventor(s)	Janik; Raymond George et al.

Light fixture with wireless resonant coupling

Abstract

A lighting device having wireless resonant coupling includes a wireless power transmitter unit and a light module that includes a light source. The wireless power transmitter unit is configured to provide power to the light module wirelessly by transmitting a power waveform to the light module. An amplitude of a fundamental frequency component of the power waveform equals an amplitude of a third harmonic frequency component of the power waveform.

Inventors:	Janik; Raymond George (Fayetteville, GA), Moghal; Khurram Zeshan (Senoia, GA)
Applicant:	SIGNIFY HOLDING B.V. (Eindhoven, NL)
Family ID:	1000008780576
Assignee:	SIGNIFY HOLDING B.V. (Eindhoven, NL)
Appl. No.:	18/279000
Filed (or PCT Filed):	February 21, 2022
PCT No.:	PCT/EP2022/054204
PCT Pub. No.:	WO2022/179968
PCT Pub. Date:	September 01, 2022

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20240164002 A1	May. 16, 2024

Foreign Application Priority Data

EP	21160716	Mar. 04, 2021
----	----------	---------------

Related U.S. Application Data

us-provisional-application US 63153750 20210225

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: H05B47/19 (20200101); H02J50/00 (20160101); H02J50/12 (20160101); H02J50/70 (20160101); H05B45/325 (20200101); H05B45/3725 (20200101); H05B47/14 (20200101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC H05B47/19 (20200101); H02J50/005 (20200101); H02J50/12 (20160201); H02J50/70 (20160201); H05B45/325 (20200101); H05B45/3725 (20200101); H05B47/14 (20200101);

Field of Classification Search

CPC: H05B (47/19); H05B (45/325); H05B (45/3725); H05B (47/14); H02J (50/005); H02J (50/12); H02J (50/70)

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
9276413	12/2015	Zhang	N/A	H02J 50/12
9723699	12/2016	Von Novak, III	N/A	H05B 47/19
2012/0212150	12/2011	Lakirovich et al.	N/A	N/A

2016/0329752	12/2015	Bae	N/A	H02J 7/00034
2017/0117752	12/2016	Kaechi	N/A	H02J 50/60
2018/0159371	12/2017	Kim	N/A	H02J 50/80
2018/0212463	12/2017	Van Boheemen et al.	N/A	N/A
2018/0269725	12/2017	Yeo	N/A	H02J 50/12
2018/0351392	12/2017	Malkin	N/A	H02J 50/12
2019/0109498	12/2018	Stingu	N/A	H03F 3/217
2019/0366866	12/2018	Cha et al.	N/A	N/A
2021/0057934	12/2020	Zhao	N/A	H02J 50/12
2021/0188106	12/2020	Asa	N/A	H02M 1/4216

FOREIGN PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Application Date	Country	CPC
108847706	12/2017	CN	N/A
2597748	12/2012	EP	N/A
20120129821	12/2011	KR	N/A
2014127036	12/2013	WO	N/A

Primary Examiner: Riyami; Abdullah A

Assistant Examiner: Kaiser; Syed M

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO PRIOR APPLICATIONS (1) This application is the U.S. National Phase application under 35 U.S.C. § 371 of International Application No. PCT/EP2022/054204, filed on Feb. 21, 2022, which claims the benefit of European Patent Application No. 21160716, filed on Mar. 4, 2021 and U.S. Provisional Application No. 63/153,750, filed on Feb. 25, 2021. These applications are hereby incorporated by reference herein.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present disclosure relates generally to lighting fixtures, and more particularly to light fixtures having a wireless power transmitter.

BACKGROUND

(2) Some light fixtures (e.g., light emitting diode (LED) light fixtures) include a wireless power transmitter that wirelessly provides power to the light source of the light fixtures via a power receiving component of the light fixtures. The power receiving component of such light fixtures is preferably consistently spaced for optimum power transfer from the wireless power transmitter of the light fixture. For example, the optimum and consistent separation can facilitate power efficiency and minimize variations in the light provided by multiple light fixtures. However, installing the wireless power transmitter and the power receiving component of light fixtures separated at an optimum and consistent distance from each other may be challenging. Thus, a solution that accommodates variations in the separation between the wireless power transmitter and the power receiving component of LED light fixtures may be desirable.

SUMMARY

(3) The present disclosure relates generally to lighting fixtures, and more particularly to light fixtures having a wireless power transmitter. In an example embodiment, a lighting device having wireless resonant coupling includes a wireless power transmitter unit and a light module that includes a light source. The wireless power transmitter unit is configured to provide power to the light module wirelessly by transmitting a power waveform to the light module. An amplitude of a fundamental frequency component of the power waveform equals an amplitude of a third harmonic frequency component of the power waveform.

(4) In another example embodiment, a method of operation of a resonant coupling wireless light fixture includes providing power, by a wireless power transmitter unit of the resonant coupling wireless light fixture, to a light module of the resonant coupling wireless light fixture by transmitting a power waveform. The method further includes receiving, by the light module, the power waveform, and providing, by the light module, a light based on the power received from the wireless power transmitter unit via the power waveform, where a fundamental frequency component of the power waveform and a third harmonic frequency component of the power waveform have equal amplitudes.

(5) These and other aspects, objects, features, and embodiments will be apparent from the following description and the appended claims.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE FIGURES

(1) Reference will now be made to the accompanying drawings, where:

(2) FIG. 1 illustrates a resonant coupling wireless light fixture according to an example embodiment;

(3) FIG. 2 is a graph showing the relationship between distance between the wireless power transmitter unit and the light module of the light fixture of FIG. 1 and leakage inductance according to an example embodiment;

(4) FIG. 3 illustrates details of the resonant coupling light fixture of FIG. 1 according to an example embodiment;

(5) FIG. 4 illustrates a wired circuit representative of the light fixture of FIGS. 1 and 3 according to an example embodiment;

(6) FIG. 5 shows a graph of the relationship between the distance D shown of FIG. 1 and the gain of the circuit of FIG. 4 with respect to the fundamental frequency of the power waveform according to an example embodiment;

(7) FIG. 6 shows a graph of the relationship between the distance D shown of FIG. 1 and the gain of the circuit of FIG. 4 with respect to the third harmonic frequency of the power waveform according to an example embodiment;

(8) FIG. 7 shows a graph of the relationship between the distance D shown in FIG. 1 and the combined gain of the circuit of FIG. 4 with respect to the fundamental and third harmonic frequencies of the power waveform of FIG. 1 according to an example embodiment;

(9) FIG. 8 illustrates a power waveform that is wirelessly provided to the light module of the resonant coupling light fixture of FIG. 1 according to an example embodiment; and

(10) FIG. 9 illustrates the fundamental, third harmonic, and fifth harmonic frequency components of the power waveform of FIGS. 1 and 8 according to an example embodiment.

(11) The drawings illustrate only example embodiments and are therefore not to be considered limiting in scope. The elements and features shown in the drawings are not necessarily to scale, emphasis instead being placed upon clearly illustrating the principles of the example embodiments. Additionally, certain dimensions or placements may be exaggerated to help visually convey such principles. In the drawings, the same reference

numerical data are used in different drawings designed like or corresponding, but not necessarily identical elements.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF EXAMPLE EMBODIMENTS

(12) In the following paragraphs, particular embodiments will be described in further detail by way of example with reference to the figures. In the description, well known components, methods, and/or processing techniques are omitted or briefly described. Furthermore, reference to various feature(s) of the embodiments is not to suggest that all embodiments must include the referenced feature(s).

(13) FIG. 1 illustrates a resonant coupling wireless light fixture **100** according to an example embodiment. In some example embodiments, the light fixture **100** may be a lighting device that provides an illumination light. The light fixture **100** may include a wireless power transmitter unit **102** and a light module **104**. The wireless power transmitter unit **102** wirelessly provides power to the light module **104**, and the light module **104** operates using the power wirelessly received from the wireless power transmitter unit **102**. The wireless power transmitter unit **102** may wirelessly provide power to the light module **104** by transmitting a power waveform **120** to the light module **104** wirelessly. As shown in FIG. 1, the wireless power transmitter unit **102** and the light module **104** may be spaced from each other by a distance D. In particular, a coil **110** of the wireless power transmitter unit **102** and a coil **112** of the light module **104** are separated by the distance D.

(14) In some example embodiments, the wireless power transmitter unit **102** includes an interface module **106** and a power waveform generator **108**. For example, the interface module **106** may be an alternating current (AC)-to-direct current (DC) converter that receives an AC voltage and outputs DC voltage. To illustrate, the interface module **106** may receive AC voltage via an input connection **122**, for example, from utility power supply. In some alternative embodiments, the interface module **106** may include a DC-to-DC converter that receives, for example, input DC voltage having a particular voltage level via the input connection **122** and outputs output DC voltage that has a different level. In some alternative embodiments, the interface module **106** may include one or more wiring connections that directly (i.e., without conversion) transfer the DC input voltage received via the input connection **122** to the power waveform generator **108**.

(15) In some example embodiments, the wireless power transmitter unit **102** includes a coil **110** that is coupled to the power waveform generator **108**. The power waveform generator **108** along with the coil **110** may generate and wirelessly transmit the power waveform **120** using the DC voltage from the interface module **106**.

(16) In some example embodiments, the light module **104** includes a coil **112**, a resonance capacitor **114**, DC power circuitry **124**, a light source **116** (e.g., LED light source), and feedback circuitry **118**. The light module **104** may receive the power waveform **120** from the wireless power transmitter unit **102** via the coil **112**. The coil **112** is coupled to the resonance capacitor **114**. The resonance capacitor **114** may include a fixed capacitor and a switched capacitor as explained below in more detail. The switched capacitor may be controlled by the feedback circuitry **118** based on the current flowing through the light source **116**. The DC power circuitry **124** may provide DC voltage/current to the light source **116** from the power received from the wireless power transmitter unit **102** via the coil **112**. For example, the DC power circuitry **124** may include a rectifier and a DC output capacitor that provide DC voltage/current to the light source **116**.

(17) In some example embodiments, the feedback circuitry **118** includes a current sensor and pulse width modulation (PWM) circuit. The current sensor may sense the current flowing through the light source **116**, and the PWM circuit may generate a PWM signal based on the current flowing through the light source **116**. For example, the PWM circuit may change (e.g., increase and decrease) and maintain the pulse width of the PWM signal based on the amount of the current flowing through the light source **116**. The PWM signal is provided to the switched capacitor of the resonance capacitor **114** to control (e.g., increase, decrease, and maintain) the capacitance of the switched capacitor based on the pulse width of the PWM signal, effectively controlling the capacitance of the resonance capacitor **114**, as can be readily understood by those of ordinary skill in the art. Changing the capacitance of the resonance capacitor **114** based on the current flowing through the light source **116** can enable the control of the power provided to the light source **116**, and thus the light emitted by the light source **116**.

(18) In some example embodiments, the power waveform **120** has characteristics that allow for variations in the distance D between the coil **110** and the coil **112** without significant variations in the light provided by the light source **116**. To illustrate, the power provided to the light source **116** and the corresponding intensity of the light provided by the light source **116** depend on the leakage inductance L that itself depends on the distance D between the coil **110** and the coil **112** as shown in FIG. 2.

(19) FIG. 2 is a graph showing the relationship between distance D separating the coil **110** of the wireless power transmitter unit **102** and the coil **112** of the light module **104** of the light fixture **100** of FIG. 1 and the resulting leakage inductance according to an example embodiment. As shown in FIG. 2, the leakage inductance L proportional to the distance D between the coils **110** and **112**. To illustrate, as the leakage inductance L increases the distance D between the coils **110** and **112** increases and as the leakage inductance L decreases the distance D between the coils **110** and **112** decreases.

(20) Referring to FIGS. 1 and 2, in some example embodiments, to accommodate different values of the distance D separating the coils **110**, **112** that correspond to different values of the leakage inductance L, the wireless power transmitter unit **102** may generate the power waveform **120** such that the power waveform **120** has a fundamental frequency component and a third harmonic frequency component that are substantially equally dominant frequency components of the power waveform **120**. For example, the amplitude of the fundamental frequency component of the power waveform **120** may be equal to the amplitude of the third harmonic frequency component as explained in more detail with respect to FIGS. 8 and 9. As can be readily understood by those of ordinary skill in the art, the amplitudes of the fundamental frequency component and the third harmonic frequency component may be slightly different from each other within a tolerance margin.

(21) As explained in more detail below, the equal or substantially equal amplitudes of the fundamental frequency component and the third harmonic frequency component can minimize the difference in the power delivered to the light source **116** at different values of the leakage inductance L corresponding to respective values of the distance D. In addition, by adjusting the capacitance of the resonance capacitor **114** based on the current flowing through the light source **116**, the differences in the power delivered to the light source **116** for a range of the values of the leakage inductance L corresponding to a range of values of the distance D can be minimized.

(22) In some alternative embodiments, the amplitude of the fundamental frequency component may be equal to both the amplitude of the third harmonic frequency component and the amplitude of the fifth harmonic frequency component of the power waveform **120**. As can be readily understood by those of ordinary skill in the art, the amplitudes of the fundamental frequency component, the third harmonic frequency component, and the fifth harmonic frequency component may be slightly different from each other within a tolerance margin. The equal or substantially equal amplitudes of the fundamental frequency component, the third harmonic frequency component, and the fifth harmonic frequency component can minimize differences in the power delivered to the light source **116** at different values of the leakage inductance L corresponding to respective values of the distance D. In addition, by adjusting the capacitance of the resonance capacitor **114** based on the current flowing through the light source **116**, the differences in the power delivered to the light source **116** for a range of the values of the leakage inductance L corresponding to a range of values of the distance D can be minimized.

(23) By using the power waveform **120** to wirelessly transmit power from the wireless power transmitter unit **102** to the light module **104**, the light fixture **100** can accommodate variations in the separation between the wireless power transmitter unit **102** and the light module **104** with relatively small or no changes in the light provided by the light fixture **100**. As a non-limiting example, the separation (i.e., the distance D) between the wireless power transmitter unit **102** and the light module **104** may be varied by up to 10 mm with no or minimal and acceptable changes in the light provided by the light fixture **100**. In some example embodiments, the distance D may be larger or smaller than 10 mm without departing from the scope of this disclosure.

(24) In some alternative embodiments, the wireless power transmitter unit **102** may include more or fewer and/or different components than shown

without departing from the scope of this disclosure. In some alternative embodiments, one or more components (e.g., the interface module **106**) of the wireless power transmitter unit **102** may be omitted without departing from the scope of this disclosure. In some alternative embodiments, the light module **104** may include more or fewer and/or different components than shown without departing from the scope of this disclosure. In some alternative embodiments, one or more components of the light module **104** may be omitted or integrated without departing from the scope of this disclosure.

(25) FIG. 3 illustrates details of the resonant coupling light fixture **100** of FIG. 1 according to an example embodiment. Referring to FIGS. 1-3, in some example embodiments, the wireless power transmitter unit **102** of the light fixture **100** may be coupled to an AC power source **302** (e.g., utility power supply) and may provide power to the light module **104** using the power waveform **120**. For example, the wireless power transmitter unit **102** may receive AC voltage from the AC power source **302** via the input connection **122**.

(26) In some example embodiments, the wireless power transmitter unit **102** of the light fixture **100** includes the interface module **106**, a pulse generator **304**, and an H-bridge circuit **308**. For example, the power waveform generator **108** described with respect to FIG. 1 may include the pulse generator **304** and the H-bridge circuit **308**. The interface module **106** may be or include an AC-to-DC converter that generates DC voltage from the AC voltage received provided by the AC power supply **302**. The interface module **106** may be coupled to the H-bridge circuit **308** and may provide the DC voltage to the H-bridge circuit **308**. The H-bridge circuit **308** may include transistors **310**, **312**, **314**, **316** that are controlled by the pulse generator **304**, for example, by driving the gates of the transistors **310**, **312**, **314**, **316** using respective gate control pulses.

(27) In some example embodiments, the pulse generator **304** may include a controller **306** that executes software code stored in a memory device to generate gate control pulses to control the operation of the H-bridge circuit **308**. The pulse generator **304** may also include other components such as a timer, etc. as can be readily understood by those of ordinary skill in the art with the benefit of the scope of this disclosure. The controller **306** may control the H-bridge circuit **308** using the gate control pulses to generate and transmit the power waveform **120** via the coil **110**. To illustrate, the pulse generator **304** may generate the gate control pulses such that the transistors **310**, **316** are on while the transistors **312**, **314** are off and such that the transistors **310**, **316** are off while the transistors **312**, **314** are on. The controller **306** may vary the duration of individual gate control pulses to define the pulse widths of pulses of the power waveform **120**. An example of the power waveform **120** generated and transmitted by the wireless power transmitter unit **102** is shown in FIG. 8.

(28) As described above, the light module **104** is designed to be installed/positioned separated by a distance D from the wireless power transmitter unit **102**. In some example embodiments, the light module **104** includes the coil **112**, a switched capacitor **318**, and a fixed capacitor **320**. The coil **112** may be coupled to the switched capacitor **318** and the fixed capacitor **320**. For example, the resonance capacitor **114** of the light module **104** described with respect to FIG. 1 may include the switched capacitor **318** and the fixed capacitor **320**. The transfer of power from the wireless power transmitter unit **102** to the light source **116** of the light module **104** depends on the switched capacitor **318** and the fixed capacitor **320** along with the leakage inductance L between the coils **110** and **112**.

(29) In some example embodiments, the light module **104** includes a rectifier **322** and a DC output capacitor **324** that provide DC voltage/current to the light source **116** based on the power waveform **120** received via the coil **112**. To illustrate, the rectifier **322** may be coupled to the switched capacitor **318** and the fixed capacitor **320**. The rectifier **322** may be a bridge rectifier as shown in FIG. 3 or may be another type of full wave rectifier as can be readily understood by those of ordinary skill in the art with the benefit of the scope of this disclosure. The DC output capacitor **324** serves to smooth out the output of the rectifier **322** as can be readily understood by those of ordinary skill in the art with the benefit of the scope of this disclosure. The intensity of the light provided by the light source **116** may depend on the amount of power delivered to the light source **116** by the wireless power transmitter unit **102**. The amount of power delivered to the light source **116** may depend on the leakage inductance L between the coils **110** and **112** and the switched capacitor **318** and the fixed capacitor **320** defining the resonance capacitor **114** as explained in more detail with respect to FIG. 4.

(30) In some example embodiments, the light module **104** includes a current sensor **326** and a PWM circuit **328**. For example, the feedback circuitry **118** of FIG. 1 may include the current sensor **326** and the PWM circuit **328**. The current sensor **326** may be coupled to the light source **116** to sense the amount of current flowing through the light source **116**. The current sensor **326** may output a DC signal indicative of the amount of current flowing through the light source **116**. The PWM circuit **328** may be coupled to the current sensor **326** and may generate a PWM signal **330** based on the amount of current flowing through the light source **116** as indicated by the current sensor **326**. For example, the PWM circuit **328** may include a DC to PWM converter circuit. The PWM circuit **328** may adjust the pulse width of the PWM signal **330** based on the amount of current flowing through the light source **116** to adjust (e.g., increase or decrease) or maintain the capacitance of the switched capacitor **318**, which can result in changing or maintaining the power transferred to the light source **116** from the wireless power transmitter unit **102**. The desired relationship between current amounts and pulse widths of the PWM signal **330** may be predetermined, for example, empirically or through calculations.

(31) In some alternative embodiments, the wireless power transmitter unit **102** may include more, fewer, and/or different components than shown without departing from the scope of this disclosure. In some alternative embodiments, one or more of components the wireless power transmitter unit **102** may be omitted without departing from the scope of this disclosure. In some alternative embodiments, the light module **104** may include more, fewer, and/or different components than shown without departing from the scope of this disclosure. For example, a different type of current sensor or rectifier may be used. In some alternative embodiments, one or more components of the light module **104** may be omitted or integrated without departing from the scope of this disclosure.

(32) FIG. 4 illustrates a wired circuit **400** representative of the light fixture **100** of FIGS. 1 and 3 according to an example embodiment. Referring to FIGS. 1-4, in some example embodiments, the circuit **400** includes a waveform generator **402** that outputs the power waveform **120**. To illustrate, the waveform generator **402** represents the wireless power transmitter unit **102** with respect to the generation of the power waveform **120**. The circuit **400** also includes a resonance inductor **404** corresponding to the leakage inductance L between the coils **110** and **112** shown in FIGS. 1 and 3. The remaining components of the circuit **400** correspond to the components of the light module **104** shown in FIGS. 1 and 3. For example, the circuit **400** includes the resonance capacitor **114** that includes the switched capacitor **318** and the fixed capacitor **320**. The switched capacitor **318** may include a capacitor **406** and a transistor **408** (e.g., a MOSFET), where the transistor **408** is controlled by the PWM circuit **328** using the PWM signal **330** to control the capacitance of the switched capacitor **318** and thus, the capacitance of the resonance capacitor **114**.

(33) In some example embodiments, the circuit **400** also includes the rectifier **322**, the DC output capacitor **324**, the light source **116**, the current sensor **326**, and the PWM circuit **328** that are included in the light module **104** shown in FIG. 3. The light source **116** may include one or more LEDs **410**, and the current sensor **326** may include a resistor **412** and an operational amplifier **414** that operate to output a signal indicative of the current flowing through the light source **116**.

(34) In some example embodiments, the gain G of the circuit **400** can be estimated/calculated using Equation 1 below:

$$(35) \quad G = \frac{1}{2 \cdot f L C \sqrt{2 \cdot f^2 + \left(\frac{1}{L^2} - \frac{1}{C^2} + \left(\frac{1}{RC}\right)^2 + \left(\frac{R+R_L}{2L}\right)^2}} \quad \text{Eq. 1}$$

(36) In Equation 1, G is the gain of the circuit **400**, which represents the efficiency of power transfer to the light source **116** from the waveform generator **402** (corresponding to the wireless power transmitter unit **102**). Further, f is a frequency of a frequency component of the power waveform **120**, L is the resonance inductance of the resonance inductor **404** corresponding to the leakage inductance L between the coils **110** and **112** shown in FIGS. 1 and 3, C is the resonance capacitance of the resonance capacitor **114**, r represents wire resistance shown in FIG. 4, and R represents the load that includes the light source **116**.

(37) As can be readily understood from Equation 1, the gain G depends on the values of the resonance capacitance C and the resonance inductance L, and the resonance inductance L depends on the distance D between the coils **110** and **112** as explained above with respect to FIG. 2. The gain G is

generally highest at the resonance frequency of the circuit **400** where the value of the resonance frequency depends on the value of the resonance inductance L that depends on the distance D. In addition, the resonance frequency of the circuit **400** depends on the value of the resonance capacitance C, which can be changed/tuned by adjusting the capacitance of the switched capacitor **318** as described above with respect to FIG. 3. (38) With respect to a particular frequency component of the power waveform **120**, the gain G of the circuit **400** is highest when the frequency of the particular frequency component matches the resonance frequency of the circuit **400**. To illustrate, for a particular value of the resonance capacitance C, a first value of the distance D may correspond to a particular value of the resonance inductance L, where the resulting value of the resonance frequency of the circuit **400** matches the frequency of the fundamental frequency component of the power waveform **120**. For example, FIG. 5 shows a graph **500** of the relationship between the distance D and the gain G with respect to a fundamental frequency of the power waveform **120** according to an example embodiment. To illustrate, in FIG. 5, the fundamental frequency (i.e., the frequency of the fundamental frequency component of the power waveform **120**) may be 25 KHz, and the resonance capacitor C may have a value of 0.45 μ F, at least at the highest gain value. As explained above with respect to FIG. 3, the resonance capacitance C may be changed/tuned to have the desired capacitance value by changing/tuning the capacitance of the switched capacitor **318**. As can be readily observed from FIG. 7, the highest value of the gain G occurs when the distance D is approximately 12 mm (millimeters). In some alternative embodiments, the gain G with respect to the fundamental frequency of the power waveform **120** may be different than shown in FIG. 5 without departing from the scope of this disclosure.

(39) In some example embodiments, for another value of the resonance capacitance C, a second value of the distance D may correspond to another value of the resonance inductance L, where the resulting value of the resonance frequency of the circuit **400** matches the frequency of the third harmonic frequency component of the power waveform **120**. For example, FIG. 6 shows a graph **600** of the relationship between the distance D and the gain G with respect to a third harmonic frequency of the power waveform **120**. In FIG. 6, the third harmonic frequency (i.e., the frequency of the third harmonic frequency component of the power waveform **120**) may be 75 KHz, and the resonance capacitor C may have a value of 0.11 μ F, at least at the highest gain value. As explained above with respect to FIG. 3, the resonance capacitance C may be changed/tuned to have the desired capacitance value by changing/tuning the capacitance of the switched capacitor **318**. As can be readily observed from FIG. 6, the highest value of the gain G occurs when the distance D is approximately 5 mm (millimeters). In some alternative embodiments, the gain G with respect to the third harmonic frequency of the power waveform **120** may be different than shown in FIG. 6 without departing from the scope of this disclosure.

(40) FIG. 7 shows a graph of the relationship between the distance D shown in FIG. 1 and the combined gain of the circuit **400** shown in FIG. 4 with respect the fundamental and third harmonic frequencies of the power waveform **120** of FIG. 1 according to an example embodiment. In FIG. 7, the peak values of the combined gain correspond to the highest values of the gain G shown in FIGS. 5 and 6. Referring to FIGS. 1-7, in contrast to the individual gains with respect to the fundamental and third harmonic frequencies shown in FIGS. 5 and 6, the combined gain shown in FIG. 7 remains within a relatively narrow range for a larger range of values of the distance D between the coils **110**, **112**. In particular, at the values of the distance D resulting in the resonant frequency of the circuit **400** matching the fundamental and third harmonic frequencies of the power waveform **120**, the difference in the values of the combined gain is minimal. To maintain the gain G in a narrow range for a range of values of the resonance inductance L, the resonance capacitance C can be set/changed by the PWM circuit **328** by controlling the capacitance of the switched capacitor **318** based on the current flowing through the light source **116**. In some alternative embodiments, the combined gain may be different than shown in FIG. 7 without departing from the scope of this disclosure.

(41) FIG. 8 illustrates the power waveform **120** (also labelled f(t) in FIG. 8) that is wirelessly provided to the light module **104** of the resonant coupling light fixture **100** of FIG. 1 according to an example embodiment, and FIG. 9 illustrates the fundamental, third harmonic, and fifth harmonic frequency components of the power waveform **120** of FIGS. 1 and 8 according to an example embodiment. Referring to FIGS. 1-9, in some example embodiments, the power waveform **120** may be a pulse wave as shown in FIG. 8. For example, as shown in FIG. 8, the power waveform **120** may be a periodic pulse wave/waveform that has a high value during first two durations D1, D2 (i.e., the first duration D1 and the second duration D2) in a half portion of a period T and a low value during second two durations D3, D4 (i.e., the third duration D3 and the fourth duration D4) in the other half portion of the period T, where the first two durations D1, D2 are separated from each other by a duration D5, where the second two durations D3, D4 are separated from each other by a duration D6, where the waveform has the low value during the duration D5, where the waveform has the high value during the duration D6. The high value (shown as 1 in FIG. 8) and the low value (shown as -1 in FIG. 8) can be scaled and/or offset as can be readily understood by those of ordinary skill in the art with the benefit of the scope of this disclosure.

(42) In some example embodiments, the duration D5 may equal the duration D6. For example, the duration D5 and the duration D6 may each be 2 δ wide as shown in FIG. 8. The sum of 2 δ and the durations D1 and D2 equals half of the period T, which generically is shown as being equal to 1 in FIG. 8 and can be scaled based on a particular frequency as can be readily understood by those of ordinary skill in the art with the benefit of the scope of this disclosure. The sum of 2 δ and the durations D3 and D4 also equals half of the period T. The sum of 3 and any one of the durations D1, D2, D3, or D4 equals a quarter of the period T.

(43) In some example embodiments, the power waveform **120** may be described as a periodic pulse wave/waveform that includes, within a period T of the pulse wave/waveform, two high pulses with the durations D1 and D2 in a half portion of the period and two low pulses with durations D3 and D4 in the other half portion of the period, where the two high pulses are separated by a low pulse with the duration D5 and where the two low pulses are separated by a high pulse with the duration D6.

(44) Equation 2 below provides a Fourier series representation of power waveform **120** represented by f(t):

$$f(t)=a_{\text{sub.v}}+\sum_{\text{sub.n}=1}^{\text{sup.28}} a_{\text{sub.n}} \cos(n\omega t)+b_{\text{sub.n}} \sin(n\omega t) \quad \text{Eq. 2}$$

where

$$(45) a_v = \frac{1}{T} \int_{t_0}^{t_0+T} f(t) dt; a_k = \frac{2}{T} \int_{t_0}^{t_0+T} f(t) \cos(k \omega t) dt; \text{ and } b_k = \frac{2}{T} \int_{t_0}^{t_0+T} f(t) \sin(k \omega t) dt,$$

where k is odd and positive integer representing to the fundamental and odd harmonics of f(t).

(46) In Equation 2, because f(t) is symmetrical and therefore has zero time-average value, a_{sub.v}=0. Further, a_{sub.k} equals zero as determined according to Eq. 3 below:

$$(47) a_k = \frac{2}{T} \left[\int_{t_0}^{t_0+\frac{T}{4}-} \cos(k \omega t) dt - \int_{t_0+\frac{T}{4}-}^{t_0+\frac{T}{4}+} \cos(k \omega t) dt + \int_{t_0+\frac{T}{4}+}^{t_0+\frac{3T}{4}-} \cos(k \omega t) dt - \int_{t_0+\frac{3T}{4}-}^{t_0+\frac{3T}{4}+} \cos(k \omega t) dt + \int_{t_0+\frac{3T}{4}+}^{t_0+T} \cos(k \omega t) dt - \int_{t_0}^{t_0+\frac{T}{4}-} \cos(k \omega t) dt \right] = 0 \quad \text{Eq. 3}$$

b_{sub.k} can be determined according to Eq. 4 below:

$$(48) b_k = \frac{2}{T} \left[\int_{t_0}^{t_0+\frac{T}{4}-} \sin(k \omega t) dt - \int_{t_0+\frac{T}{4}-}^{t_0+\frac{T}{4}+} \sin(k \omega t) dt + \int_{t_0+\frac{T}{4}+}^{t_0+\frac{3T}{4}-} \sin(k \omega t) dt - \int_{t_0+\frac{3T}{4}-}^{t_0+\frac{3T}{4}+} \sin(k \omega t) dt + \int_{t_0+\frac{3T}{4}+}^{t_0+T} \sin(k \omega t) dt - \int_{t_0}^{t_0+\frac{T}{4}-} \sin(k \omega t) dt \right] \quad \text{Eq. 4}$$

(49) Equation 4 can be reduced to Equation 5 shown below:

$$(50) b_k = \frac{4-8(-1)^{\frac{(k+1)}{2}} \sin(2k\pi\delta)}{k} \quad \text{Eq. 5} \quad \text{where k is odd and positive integer corresponding to the fundamental and odd harmonic frequency components}$$

of f(t) (i.e., power waveform **120**). Because a_{sub.v} and a_{sub.k} in Equation 2 are zero, Equation 2 is reduced to Equations 6 and 7 shown below:

$$f(t)=\sum_{\text{sub.n}=1}^{\text{sup.}\infty} b_{\text{sub.n}} \sin(n\omega t) \quad \text{Eq. 6}$$

$$f(t)=b_{\text{sub.1}} \sin(\omega t)+b_{\text{sub.3}} \sin(3\omega t)+b_{\text{sub.5}} \sin(5\omega t)+\dots \quad \text{Eq. 7 where}$$

(51) $b_{\text{sub.k}} = \frac{2}{T} \int_{t_0}^{t_0+T} f(t) \sin(k \omega t) dt$. In Equation 7, for k=1, b_{sub.k} is b_{sub.1} and represents the amplitude of the fundamental frequency component. For k=3, b_{sub.k} is b_{sub.3} and represents the amplitude of the third harmonic component. For k=5, b_{sub.k} is b_{sub.5} and represents the amplitude of the third

harmonic component.

(52) TABLE-US-00001 TABLE 1 shows simplified forms of Equation 5 for different values of k with the period T set to 1. $k \text{ b.sub.k } 1 \frac{4 - 8\sin(2)}{3}$
 $\frac{4 + 8\sin(6)}{3} \text{ } 5 \frac{4 - 8\sin(10)}{5}$

(53) As shown in FIG. 9, the power waveform 120 may have a fundamental frequency component 902 and a third harmonic frequency component 904. In contrast to a typical square waveform, where an amplitude of the third harmonic frequency component is one-third of the amplitude of the fundamental frequency component, in FIG. 9, the amplitude of the third harmonic frequency component 904 of the power waveform 120 equals the amplitude of the fundamental frequency component 902. To generate the power waveform 120 of FIG. 8 that includes the frequency components shown in FIG. 9, the durations D5 and D6 shown in FIG. 8, which equal 2δ each, are determined by solving for δ in Equation 5 using the corresponding equations for b.sub.1 and b.sub.3 in Table 1 set equal to each other.

(54) To illustrate, δ equals 0.0272 and 2δ (i.e., each duration D5, D6) equals 0.0544 (i.e., 5.44% of T) in FIG. 8 when the fundamental frequency component 902 and the third harmonic frequency component 904 have equal amplitudes as shown in FIG. 9 (i.e., when b.sub.1 is set equal to b.sub.3). As shown in FIG. 9, the fifth harmonic component 906 of the power waveform 120 has an amplitude that is a fraction of the amplitude of the fundamental frequency component 902. Referring to FIGS. 1-9, if, for example, the frequency of the power waveform 120 is 100 KHz, T equals 10 μs, and 2 δ equals 0.544 μs. After the durations D5 and D6 are determined, the durations D1-D4 may be determined based on the durations D5 and D6 and the period T as can be readily understood by those of ordinary skill in the art with the benefit of the scope of this disclosure. The wireless power transmitter unit 102 of FIG. 1 may generate the power waveform 120 with the desired values of the durations (i.e., D1, D2, D3, D4, D5, D6) such that the fundamental frequency component 902 and the third harmonic frequency component 904 of the power waveform 120 have equal or substantially equal amplitudes.

(55) Because the fundamental frequency component 902 and the third harmonic frequency component 904 are equal and because the reasonably consistent gain G of the light fixture 100 of FIGS. 1 and 3 (as represented by the circuit 400 of FIG. 4) at the frequencies of the frequency components 902, 904, the amount of power transferred to the light source 116 of the light fixture 100 and the light provided by the light source 116 can remain reasonably consistent at different separations of the wireless power transmitter unit 102 and the light module 104. In addition, because the gain G of the light fixture 100 of FIGS. 1 and 3 is within a relatively narrow range for a range of values of the distance D as shown in FIG. 7, the amount of power transferred to the light source 116 of the light fixture 100 and the light provided by the light source 116 can remain reasonably consistent for a range of the distance D.

(56) Referring to FIGS. 1-9, in general, the method of operation of the light fixture 100 in providing a light includes the step of providing power, by the wireless power transmitter unit 102, wirelessly to the light module 104 by wirelessly transmitting the power waveform 120. The method further includes the steps of receiving, by the light module 104, the power waveform 120 transmitted by the wireless power transmitter unit 102 and providing, by the light module 104, a light based on the power received from the wireless power transmitter unit 102 via the power waveform 120. As described above, the fundamental frequency component 902 of the power waveform 120 and the third harmonic frequency component 904 of the power waveform 120 have equal amplitudes.

(57) In some alternative embodiments, the power waveform 120 may be generated such that the amplitude of the fifth harmonic component 906 and/or another frequency component of the power waveform 120 has/have the same amplitude as the fundamental frequency component 902 and the third harmonic frequency component 904 by determining the durations D1-D6 of the power waveform 120 in a similar manner as described above with respect to the fundamental frequency component 902 and the third harmonic frequency component 904. In some alternative embodiments, the power waveform 120 may have different durations, pulses, etc. than shown while having the same amplitude for different frequency components without departing from the scope of this disclosure.

(58) Although particular embodiments have been described herein in detail, the descriptions are by way of example. The features of the embodiments described herein are representative and, in alternative embodiments, certain features, elements, and/or steps may be added or omitted. Additionally, modifications to aspects of the embodiments described herein may be made by those skilled in the art without departing from the scope of the following claims, the scope of which are to be accorded the broadest interpretation so as to encompass modifications and equivalent structures.

Claims

1. A lighting device having wireless resonant coupling, the lighting device comprising: a wireless power transmitter unit including a first coil configured to wirelessly transmit a power waveform; a light module comprising a light source and a second coil located at a distance from the first coil and configured to receive the power waveform, the light module configured to provide a light, wherein the wireless power transmitter unit is configured to provide power to the light module wirelessly by transmitting a power waveform to the light module and wherein an amplitude of a fundamental frequency component of the power waveform equals an amplitude of a third harmonic frequency component of the power waveform to minimize differences in the power waveform delivered to the light source at different values of the distance.
2. The lighting device of claim 1, wherein the power waveform is a periodic pulse wave having a high value during a first duration and during a second period and a low value during a third duration and during a fourth duration, wherein the first period and the second period are in a first half portion of a period of the periodic pulse wave and separated from each other by a fifth duration, and wherein the third period and the fourth period are in second half portion of the period and separated from each other by a sixth duration.
3. The lighting device of claim 2, wherein the periodic pulse wave has the low value during the first duration and wherein the periodic pulse wave has the high value during the second duration.
4. The lighting device of claim 2, wherein the first two durations are equal to each other and wherein the second two durations are equal to each other.
5. The lighting device of claim 2, wherein the first duration D5 and the second duration each is approximately 5.44 percent of the period of the periodic pulse wave.
6. The lighting device of claim 1, wherein an amplitude of a fifth harmonic frequency component of the power waveform is approximately one-fifth of the amplitude of the fundamental frequency component of the power waveform.
7. The lighting device of claim 1, wherein an amplitude of a fifth harmonic frequency component of the power waveform equals the amplitude of the fundamental frequency component of the power waveform.
8. The lighting device of claim 1, wherein the wireless power transmitter unit is configured to receive alternating current voltage and generate the power waveform based on the AC voltage.
9. The lighting device of claim 8, wherein the wireless power transmitter unit comprises an AC to DC converter configured to generate a DC voltage from the AC voltage and wherein the wireless power transmitter unit is configured to generate the power waveform using the DC voltage.
10. The lighting device of claim 1, wherein the wireless power transmitter unit is configured to receive direct current voltage and generate the power waveform based on the DC voltage.
11. The lighting device of claim 1, wherein the wireless power transmitter unit comprises a controller and an H-bridge circuit and wherein the controller is configured to control the H-bridge circuit to generate the power waveform.
12. The lighting device of claim 11, wherein the first coil is coupled to the H-bridge circuit and configured to wirelessly transmit the power

waveform and the second coil is configured to receive the power waveform.

13. The lighting device of claim 11, wherein the light module further comprises a switched capacitor having a capacitance that is controlled based on a DC current flowing through the light source.

14. The lighting device of claim 13, wherein the light module further comprises a current sensor and a pulse width modulation circuit, wherein the current sensor is configured to sense the DC current flowing through the light source, and wherein the PWM circuit is configured to control the switched capacitor based on the DC current flowing through the light source indicated by the current sensor.

15. A method of operation of a resonant coupling wireless light fixture, the method comprising: providing power, by a wireless power transmitter unit including a first coil of the resonant coupling wireless light fixture, wirelessly to a light module having a second coil located at a distance from the first coil of the resonant coupling wireless light fixture by wirelessly transmitting a power waveform; receiving, by the light module, the power waveform transmitted by the wireless power transmitter unit; and minimizing differences in the power waveform delivered to the light source at different values of the distance by providing, by the light module, a light based on the power received from the wireless power transmitter unit via the power waveform, wherein a fundamental frequency component of the power waveform and a third harmonic frequency component of the power waveform have equal amplitudes.
